

Daily Content Intel

August 26, 2026

Topic A — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

A kid came back from ACL surgery with a knee that tested clean and an ankle that couldn't hold him.

Okay, so there's a study out this month comparing 2 graft choices for ACL reconstruction. The hamstring tendon, which most people know about, and the peroneus longus, which is a tendon running down the outside of your lower leg into your foot. 12 months out, both groups scored the same on the questionnaires. Knee scores fine. Everybody looked recovered on paper.

Then they actually tested them. The peroneus longus group had hop test asymmetry between 14 and 21 percent.

The hamstring group was under 8. And the deficits showed up in ankle plantar flexion and ankle eversion, which is exactly where they took the graft from, and those athletes swayed more and took longer to stabilize when they landed.

So here's what I take from it. Surgery leaves a second problem behind, at the site they borrowed from, and it rarely gets a rehab plan of its own. If you had a peroneus longus graft, your calf and the outside of that ankle need real loading, and your hop symmetry number is telling you about more than your knee.

Ask which graft you got. It changes what you train.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: A kid came back from ACL surgery with a knee that tested clean and an ankle

that couldn't hold him.

Spoken script (word for word):

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 Knee cleared. Ankle didn't.
- 0:12 2 grafts. Same knee scores.
- 0:28 Hop asymmetry: 14-21% vs under 8%
- 0:40 Deficit was in the ankle
- 0:55 Surgery leaves 2 sites, not 1
- 1:10 Ask which graft you got

Caption (copy-paste ready):

A study out this month followed athletes 12 months after ACL reconstruction, split by graft choice.

On the questionnaires, both groups looked the same. Knee scores fine, recovered on paper.

Then they tested them. The peroneus longus group had hop test asymmetry between 14 and 21 percent. The hamstring graft group was under 8. The strength deficits sat in ankle plantar flexion and eversion, right where the graft came from, and those athletes took longer to stabilize on landing.

The knee gets all the rehab attention. The donor site gets almost none.

If you're coming back from an ACL, know which graft you got, because it changes what your rehab has to cover. And if your hop symmetry is stuck, the problem might be below the knee.

Working with athletes on return to sport:
threshold.clientsecure.me

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#ACLrehab #ACLrecovery #returntosport
#physicaltherapy #sportsPT
#athletedevelopment #footballtraining
#lacrosse #strengthandconditioning

#kneerehab #ankle #hoptest

Personalize this

- Which graft have your post-op ACL athletes actually come to you with, and have you seen a hamstring-graft athlete rehab differently from a patellar or peroneus longus athlete in how their hop testing progresses?
- When you run hop symmetry on a returning football or lacrosse athlete and the number is stuck in the teens, what do you check below the knee before you assume it's a quad problem?
- Where does the ankle sit in your CROSS framework for a late-stage ACL athlete, and what does the actual loading look like (calf work, eversion, single-leg landing) in the weeks before you clear someone for cutting?

Shoot notes:

- Open on your face already mid-thought and already talking about the kid, not settling into frame. The brief's single biggest leak is 0-8s and the recurring

cause is a flat, low-energy mid-sentence open, so the first word out has to be the story.

- Shoot against a clean wall, not the gym floor with windows and racks behind you. Two of the three logged drop-off frames name a visually busy gym background competing with you.
- Frame tight, eyes in the upper third. The other logged drop-off frame calls out dead ceiling space above the head, so crop it out.

Hook shape: Story hook, "Story hook: 60.9% (-3.2pp vs average, n=4). It survives the scroll better than anything else you open with."

Screenshots:

- title | <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42624924/> | "Peroneus longus autograft in anterior cruciate ligament reconstruction impairs ankle strength, balance and jump performance despite preserved knee function"

- physiology |
<https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42624924/>
| "the PLT group showed significantly higher inter-limb functional asymmetry in SLHTs (14.06%-21.34%) compared to the ST group (3.95%-7.85%)"
- actionable |
<https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42624924/>
| "These functional deficits suggest that PLT autografts should be used with caution, particularly in athletes who depend on optimal ankle stability for athletic performance."

Sources:

- <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42624924/>
- <https://doi.org/10.1007/s00264-026-06998-7>

Topic B — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Your combine numbers barely predict whether you actually get drafted.

New study out this week, 3,681 NFL combine participants, every athlete who completed all 6 tests. The researchers broke the testing down into what it's really measuring, momentum and power and change of direction and strength, and then they asked one question. Does any of it predict who gets picked?

Barely. The prediction models came back poor. And in a few position groups, the undrafted guys actually tested better than the drafted guys.

Now I want to be careful here, because the testing does do something. It explained a real chunk of the physical difference between players at the same

position, so it tells you where an athlete is thin. The authors say it plainly. Once you clear the underlying physical thresholds, the numbers stop separating you.

That's the part that matters for a high school kid on the showcase circuit.

Clear the threshold. Get strong, get fast, be able to change direction when you're tired. Then go put it on film in an actual game, because that's what's deciding it.

Chasing another tenth of a second past the threshold buys you very little.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: Your combine numbers barely predict whether you actually get drafted.

Spoken script (word for word):

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completed all 6 tests. The researchers broke the testing down into what it's really measuring, momentum and power and change of direction and strength, and then they asked one question. Does any of it predict who gets picked?

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Chasing another tenth of a second past the threshold buys you very little.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 Combine numbers barely predict the draft
- 0:10 3,681 athletes. All 6 tests.
- 0:25 Prediction models: poor
- 0:33 Undrafted guys sometimes tested better
- 0:48 Testing still finds where you're thin
- 1:00 Clear the threshold, then play
- 1:12 Film is deciding it

Caption (copy-paste ready):

3,681 NFL combine participants. Every athlete who completed all 6 tests.

Researchers reduced the testing down to what it actually measures, momentum, power, change of direction, and strength, then checked whether any of it predicted draft status.

It barely did. The models came back poor, and in several position groups the undrafted

players tested better than the drafted ones.

The testing still has a job. It explained a real amount of the physical difference between players at the same position, so it shows you where an athlete is underbuilt. What it doesn't do is separate you once you've cleared the physical thresholds the position demands.

Which is the whole lesson for a high school athlete living on the showcase circuit. Clear the threshold: get strong, get fast, hold your change of direction under fatigue. Then go play well on film.

Another tenth of a second past the threshold is worth less than most people are paying for it.

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Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

#footballtraining #highschoolfootball

#combinetraining #speedtraining

#strengthandconditioning

#athletedevelopment #recruiting #lacrosse

#sportsscience #changeofdirection

#youthsports #performance

Personalize this

- What do you actually tell the high school football and lacrosse families who ask whether combine or showcase testing numbers are worth training for, and has that answer changed as you've programmed more HS football?
- In your own programming, what are the thresholds you want an athlete to clear before you'd spend a block chasing a testing number (a strength standard, a sprint benchmark, change of direction under fatigue)?
- You've said strength without speed is a paperweight. Where does testing fit into how you decide an athlete is ready for their season, versus ready for a showcase?

Shoot notes:

- Lead with the claim on camera and with your energy up. This one is a statement opener, so the flat, low-energy delivery flagged in every logged drop-off frame will kill it faster than it kills a story hook.

- Plain background again, and stand closer to camera than feels natural. The 0-8s leak is 27.5pp at the median and busy gym backgrounds are named in the drop-off frames.
- Let the "Barely." land as its own beat with a hard stop before you keep going. The pattern the brief rewards is claim first, then the explanation.

Hook shape: Statement hook, claim-first, allowed under the gate because the first line carries the claim itself, and Lars's 3 top performers by completion are all statement hooks ("Strength without speed is a paperweight", 13.6%).

Screenshots:

- title | <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42641168/>
| "The NFL Scouting Combine Explains Within-Position Physical Performance Variance But Is a Poor Predictor of Draft Outcomes"
- physiology | <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42641168/>
| "with undrafted players having

unexpectedly superior performance component scores than drafted players across several performance qualities"

- actionable | <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42641168/> | "These results suggest that physical performance alone does not account for most variance in draft status once underlying performance thresholds are met."

Sources:

- <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42641168/>
- <https://doi.org/10.1519/JSC.00000000000005654>

Reference

Runner-up topics

- "Reframing Hamstring Strain Injury Risk in Soccer: A Sprint Mechanism-Oriented 'Hardware-Software' Perspective" (Sports Health), hardware vs software framing for why hamstrings tear at top speed. Hold until the hamstring family cools off, last cited 2026-08-13.
- "Sex-specific knee joint strength and muscular endurance profiles in healthy adolescents" (J Sports Sci, PMID 42640141), limb asymmetry showed up on the endurance task and stayed hidden on isometric testing. Good "your strength test is too short" angle.
- "Position-Specific Differences in Physical and Technical-Tactical Match Demands Across FIFA U17, U20, and Men's World Cups" (IJSP, PMID 42632629), what changes in the demand as athletes age up. Maps onto HS to college transition.

Sources scanned today

- Newsletter digest
newsletter_digest_2026-08-26.pdf, 1 source processed (Dr. Mercola promo email, coffee timing + supplement ads). No usable clinical finding. Skipped as promo.
- PubMed E-utilities, last 8 days, sorted by entry date. Four queries run: sprint / change of direction / speed in athletes; ACL / hamstring / return to sport; youth and adolescent resistance training and plyometrics. Roughly 60 fresh records reviewed by title, 4 abstracts pulled in full.
- Selected: peroneus longus vs semitendinosus ACL graft donor-site study (Int Orthop, Aug 21) and the NFL Combine draft-prediction analysis (J Strength Cond Res, Aug 25).
- Considered and passed: "Reframing Hamstring Strain Injury Risk in Soccer" (Sports Health), hamstring/sprint family already cited 2026-08-11 and 2026-08-13. "Effects of Cognitive-Motor Demands on ACL Landing Biomechanics" (Sports Health), near-duplicate of the dual-task/visual-disruption paper cited

2026-08-21. "Redefining Readiness, RTS Criteria" (Sports Health), narrative review, no hard numbers for a screenshot gem.

- WebSearch on NSCA / BJSM / JOSPT August 2026 returned no dated last-7-day items; general web search consistently surfaced 2023-2025 reviews rather than current papers. PubMed direct query was the productive channel.
- Unreachable: pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov blocks curl and WebFetch with a cookie interstitial (HTTP 203). Verbatim screenshot targets were confirmed against the live rendered page in a real browser instead, all 6 located.
- Hook brief Social Media/content-brief.md read, generated 2026-08-26T06:45Z, fresh.